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Indian Premier League

The **Indian Premier League** (**IPL**) is a professional Twenty20 (T20) cricket league in India, organised by the Board of Control for Cricket in India (BCCI).[1] Founded in 2007, it features ten city-based franchise teams.[2] The IPL is the most popular and richest cricket league in the world and the 13th richest sporting league in the world by revenue. It is held annually between March and May. It has an exclusive window in the Future Tours Programme of the International Cricket Council, resulting in fewer international tours occurring during the seasons.[3] It is also the most viewed Indian sports event, per the Broadcast Audience Research Council.[4][5]

In 2010, the IPL became the first sporting event to broadcast live on YouTube.[6][7] In 2014, it ranked sixth in attendance among all sports leagues.[8] Inspired by the success of the IPL, other Indian sports leagues have been established.[a][11][12] The IPL is the second-richest sports league in the world by per-match value, after the National Football League.[13] In 2023, the league sold its media rights for the next four seasons for US$6.4 billion to Viacom18 and Star Sports,[14] which meant that each IPL match was valued at $13.4 million.[15] As of 2025, there have been 18 seasons of the tournament. The current champions are the Royal Challengers Bengaluru, who won the 2025 season after defeating the Punjab Kings in the final.

A women's edition of the Indian Premier League, known as the Women's Premier League, was established in 2022 and had its first season in 2023.[16][17]

Indian Premier League

Countries	India
Administrator	Board of Control for Cricket in India
Headquarters	Mumbai, India
Format	Twenty20
First edition	2008
Latest edition	2025
Next edition	2026
Tournament format	Double round-robin format followed by playoffs
Current champion	Royal Challengers Bengaluru (1st title)
Most successful	Chennai Super Kings Mumbai Indians (5 titles each)
Most runs	Virat Kohli (8,661)
Most wickets	Yuzvendra Chahal (221)
TV	List of broadcasters
Website	iplt20.com (https://www.iplt20.com/)

History

Background

In April 2007, Essel Group launched the Indian Cricket League (ICL) in partnership with IL&FS.[18][19] The ICL was not recognized by the Board of Control for Cricket in India (BCCI) or the International Cricket Council (ICC). Moreover, the BCCI was unhappy about its committee members joining the ICL executive board.[20][21] In response, the BCCI increased the prize money for its domestic tournaments and imposed lifetime bans on players who joined the ICL, which it considered a rebel league.[22][23]

Foundation

On 13 September 2007, as the 2007 ICC World Twenty20 began, the BCCI launched the Indian Premier League, an annual franchise-based Twenty20 cricket competition.[24] The inaugural season was scheduled to start in April 2008, commencing with a "high-profile ceremony" in New Delhi. BCCI vice-president Lalit Modi, who led the IPL initiative, provided details of the tournament, including its format, prize money, franchise revenue system, and squad composition rules. The league, to be managed by a seven-person governing council, would also serve as the qualifying mechanism for that year's Champions League Twenty20.[24][25]

To determine team ownership, an auction for the franchises was held on 24 January 2008. The reserve prices for the eight franchises totalled $400 million,[23] but the auction ultimately raised $723.59 million.[26] The league officially commenced in April 2008, featuring Chennai Super Kings (CSK), Mumbai Indians (MI), Delhi Daredevils (DD), Kings XI Punjab (KXIP), Deccan Chargers (DC), Rajasthan Royals (RR), Kolkata Knight Riders (KKR), and Royal Challengers Bangalore (RCB).[27]

In 2009, the BCCI and other national boards offered amnesty to rival ICL's players and officials, provided they terminated their contracts. The resulting player exodus and financial difficulties forced ICL to shut down later that year.[28][29][30]

Winners of the Indian Premier League

Season	Winners
2008	Rajasthan Royals
2009	Deccan Chargers
2010	Chennai Super Kings
2011	Chennai Super Kings (2)
2012	Kolkata Knight Riders
2013	Mumbai Indians
2014	Kolkata Knight Riders (2)
2015	Mumbai Indians (2)
2016	Sunrisers Hyderabad
2017	Mumbai Indians (3)
2018	Chennai Super Kings (3)
2019	Mumbai Indians (4)
2020	Mumbai Indians (5)
2021	Chennai Super Kings (4)
2022	Gujarat Titans
2023	Chennai Super Kings (5)
2024	Kolkata Knight Riders (3)
2025	Royal Challengers Bengaluru

Expansions and terminations

New franchises, Pune Warriors India and Kochi Tuskers Kerala, joined the league before the fourth season in 2011.[31] The Sahara Adventure Sports Group purchased the Pune franchise for $370 million, while Rendezvous Sports World bought the Kochi franchise for $333.3 million.[31] The Kochi franchise was terminated after just one season due to their failure to pay the BCCI the 10% bank guarantee element of the franchise fee.[32]

In September 2012, the Deccan Chargers franchise agreement was terminated after the BCCI failed to find new owners.[33] In October, an auction was held for a replacement franchise; Sun TV Network won the bid for what became the Hyderabad franchise;[34] the team was named Sunrisers Hyderabad.[35]

Pune Warriors India withdrew from the IPL in May 2013 due to financial differences with the BCCI.[36] The BCCI officially terminated the franchise in October, and the league reverted to eight teams.[37]

In June 2015, the two-time champions Chennai Super Kings and the inaugural season champions Rajasthan Royals were suspended for two seasons following their involvement in a spot-fixing and betting scandal.[38] The two teams were replaced for two seasons by Rising Pune Supergiant and Gujarat Lions, based in Pune and Rajkot, respectively.[39][40]

A match during the 2008 IPL inaugural season in Chennai

Due to the COVID-19 pandemic, the venue for the 2020 season was moved and games were played in the United Arab Emirates.[41][42] In August 2021, the BCCI announced that two new franchises, based in two of six shortlisted cities, would join the league in the 2022 season.[43][44] In closed bidding held in October, the RPSG Group and CVC Capital won the bids for the teams, paying ₹7,000 crore (US$830 million) and ₹5,200 crore (US$620 million), respectively.[45][46] The teams were subsequently named Lucknow Super Giants and Gujarat Titans.

Several IPL franchise owners have expanded their business by acquiring teams in other franchise leagues, such as the West Indies' Caribbean Premier League (CPL), South Africa's SA20, the UAE's International League T20 (ILT20) and the USA's Major League Cricket (MLC).

In 2023, owners of three existing IPL teams – Mumbai Indians, Delhi Capitals and Royal Challengers Bengaluru secured the rights for the homonymous franchises in the Women's Premier League.[47]

In addition to these acquisitions, Delhi Capitals also bought a stake in MLC's Seattle Orcas.[48]

In 2025, stakes in teams from The Hundred became available. RPSG Group (Lucknow Super Giants) bought a 70% stake in Manchester Originals for around £81m. Reliance Industries (Mumbai Indians) bought a 49% stake in the Oval Invincibles for £60m,[49] renaming the team MI London in December 2025.[50] Yorkshire sold 100% of Northern Superchargers to Sun Group (Sunrisers Hyderabad) for £100m,[51] before announcing the team would be known as Sunrisers Leeds in November 2025.[52] The GMR Group (Delhi Capitals) had already acquired Hampshire in a 2024 deal, including the club's 51% stake in the Southern Brave[53] and bought the remaining 49% for around £48m.[54]

IPL (Men's)	WPL (Women's)	The Hundred (Men's & Women's)	T20 Blast (Men's & Women's)	SA20 (Men's)	ILT20 (Men's)	CPL (Men's)	MLC (Men's)
Chennai Super Kings				Joburg Super Kings			Texas Super Kings
Delhi Capitals	Delhi Capitals	Southern Brave	Hampshire	Pretoria Capitals	Dubai Capitals		Seattle Orcas[b]
Gujarat Titans							
Kolkata Knight Riders					Abu Dhabi Knight Riders	Trinbago Knight Riders	Los Angeles Knight Riders
Lucknow Super Giants		Manchester Super Giants[b]		Durban's Super Giants			
Mumbai Indians	Mumbai Indians	MI London[b]		MI Cape Town	MI Emirates		MI New York
Punjab Kings						Saint Lucia Kings	
Rajasthan Royals				Paarl Royals		Barbados Royals	
Royal Challengers Bengaluru	Royal Challengers Bengaluru						
Sunrisers Hyderabad		Sunrisers Leeds		Sunrisers Eastern Cape			

Organization

The IPL's headquarters are located in the Cricket Centre, next to the Wankhede Stadium in Churchgate, Mumbai. The Governing Council is responsible for the league's functions, including the organization of tournaments. As of March 2025, its members included:[55]

- Arun Singh Dhumal – Chairman[56][57]
- Devajit Saikia – Honorary Secretary, BCCI, Member
- Prabhtej Singh Bhatia – Honorary Treasurer, BCCI, Member
- Avishek Dalmiya – Member
- Vankina Chamundeswaranath – Indian Cricketers' Association's representative, Member
- CM Sane – CAG Nominee, Member

Prize money

The 2022 season of the IPL offered total prize money of ₹46.5 crore (equivalent to ₹49 crore or US$5.8 million in 2023), with the winning team netting ₹20 crore (equivalent to ₹21 crore or US$2.5 million in 2023) and the second-placed team ₹13 crore (equivalent to ₹14 crore or US$1.6 million in 2023).[58][59] League rules mandate that half of any prize money must be distributed among the franchise's players.[60] Royal Challengers Bengaluru won their first IPL title in 2025, receiving ₹20 crore, while runners-up Punjab Kings earned ₹12 crore.[61]

Rules and format

The IPL has several rules which vary from the established laws of cricket or those used in other Twenty20 leagues:

- IPL games incorporate television timeouts. Each team is given a two-and-a-half-minute "strategic time-out" during each innings. One must be taken by the bowling team between the conclusion of the 6th and 9th overs and the other by the batting team between the end of the 13th and 16th overs. A penalty may be imposed if umpires find teams misusing this privilege.[62]
- Since the 2018 season, the Decision Review System (DRS) has been used in all IPL matches, allowing each team two opportunities in each innings to review an on-field umpire's decision.[63] From the 2023 season, this was extended to allow the review of wides and no-balls.[64]
- If the bowling team does not complete its overs in the allocated time, it may place only four fielders outside of the fielding restrictions circle for the remainder of the innings,[64] or the match referee may impose financial sanctions on the bowling team after the match, with players fined a proportion of their match fee.[65]
- Teams can use a substitute, termed an "impact player", from a list of five players named as possible substitutes. The substitution can be made before the start of the innings, when a wicket falls, when a batter retires or at the end of an over. Both teams can introduce a substitute once per match.[66][67]
- Teams can declare their playing eleven to the match referee before or after the toss.[66]
- A five-run penalty is imposed if a fielder or wicket-keeper makes an unfair movement while the bowler is bowling and the ball is designated as dead ball.[68][64][66]
- Teams can include a maximum of four overseas players in their playing eleven. If a team wants an overseas player as impact player, then it must include a maximum of three overseas players in their playing eleven.[67]
- Squads can include a maximum of 25 players, including up to eight overseas players.[69]
- Since the 2024 season, bowlers have been allowed to deliver two bouncers an over. This change in playing conditions was trialled during the 2023–24 Syed Mushtaq Ali Trophy, India's domestic T20 tournament.[70]

Teams

The IPL began in 2008 IPL with eight teams. Over the years, the league saw several team changes. Deccan Chargers, were terminated in 2012 due to financial issues and were replaced by Sunrisers Hyderabad in 2013. Kochi Tuskers Kerala debuted in 2011 but lasted only one season before being terminated for contract breaches. Pune Warriors India participated from 2011 IPL to 2013 IPL but withdrew due to financial disputes. In 2016, Chennai Super Kings (CSK) and Rajasthan Royals (RR) were suspended for two years due to the 2013 betting scandal, leading to the temporary inclusion of Rising Pune Supergiant and Gujarat Lions, both of which played in 2016 IPL and 2017 IPL before being dissolved when CSK and RR returned in 2018 IPL. In 2022 IPL, the league expanded again with the introduction of Gujarat Titans and Lucknow Super Giants, making it a ten-team tournament. Over time, some teams underwent rebranding, such as Delhi Daredevils becoming Delhi Capitals in 2019 and Kings XI Punjab rebranding as Punjab Kings in 2021. Chennai Super Kings and Mumbai Indians remain the most successful franchises, winning five IPL titles each.[71] As of the 2025 season, the league consists of 10 teams.

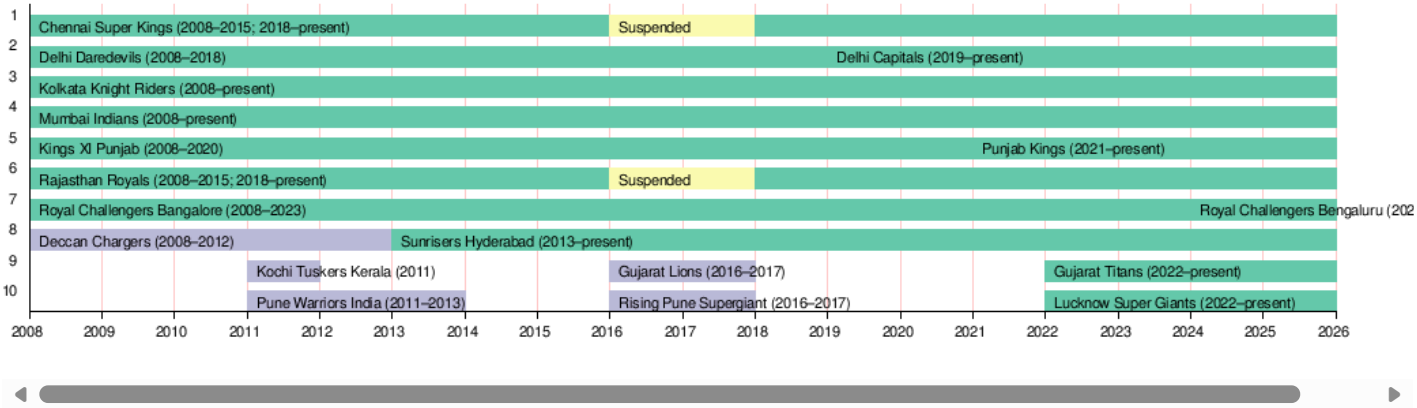
All 10 IPL teams in the cities they are based in

Team	City	State	Home ground	Debut	Captain	Head coach	Owner(s)	Ref
Chennai Super Kings	Chennai	Tamil Nadu	M. A. Chidambaram Stadium	2008	Ruturaj Gaikwad	Stephen Fleming	Chennai Super Kings Cricket Limited	
Delhi Capitals	New Delhi	Delhi	Arun Jaitley Stadium	2008	Axar Patel	Hemang Badani	GMR Group (50%) JSW Group (50%)	[72]
Gujarat Titans	Ahmedabad	Gujarat	Narendra Modi Stadium	2022	Shubman Gill	Ashish Nehra	Torrent Group (67%) CVC Capital (33%)	[73]
Kolkata Knight Riders	Kolkata	West Bengal	Eden Gardens	2008	Ajinkya Rahane	Abhishek Nayar	Shah Rukh Khan (55%) Mehta Group (45%)	[73]
Lucknow Super Giants	Lucknow	Uttar Pradesh	Ekana Stadium	2022	Rishabh Pant	Justin Langer	RP-Sanjiv Goenka Group	[74]
Mumbai Indians	Mumbai	Maharashtra	Wankhede Stadium	2008	Hardik Pandya	Mahela Jayawardene	Reliance Industries	[75]
Punjab Kings	New Chandigarh	Punjab	Maharaja Yadavindra Singh Stadium	2008	Shreyas Iyer	Ricky Ponting	Mohit Burman (48%) Ness Wadia (23%) Preity Zinta (23%) Karan Paul (6%)	[76]
Rajasthan Royals	Jaipur	Rajasthan	Sawai Mansingh Stadium	2008	Riyan Parag	Kumar Sangakkara	Manoj Badale (65%) RedBird (15%) Lachlan Murdoch (13%) Other Investors (7%)	[77]
Royal Challengers Bengaluru	Bengaluru	Karnataka	M. Chinnaswamy Stadium	2008	Rajat Patidar	Andy Flower	United Spirits	[78]
Sunrisers Hyderabad	Hyderabad	Telangana	Rajiv Gandhi Stadium	2013	Pat Cummins	Daniel Vettori	Sun TV Network	[79]

Defunct teams

Team	City	State	Home ground	Debut	Dissolved	Owner(s)
Deccan Chargers	Hyderabad	Andhra Pradesh[80]	Rajiv Gandhi Stadium	2008	2012	Deccan Chronicle
Kochi Tuskers Kerala	Kochi	Kerala	Jawaharlal Nehru Stadium	2011	2012	Rendezvous Sports World
Pune Warriors India	Pune	Maharashtra	MCA Stadium	2011	2013	Sahara India Pariwar
Rising Pune Supergiant				2016	2018	RP-Sanjiv Goenka Group
Gujarat Lions	Rajkot	Gujarat	Niranjan Shah Stadium	2016	2018	Intex Technologies

Timeline of teams



Present teams Former teams Suspended

Squads

A team can acquire players through the annual player auction, trading with other teams during trading windows, and signing replacements for unavailable players.

Player acquisition

For the 2025 IPL season, the total salary cap for each team is ₹120 crore. Each team must spend at least 75% of their total salary cap. Each squad must have a minimum of 18 players, a maximum of 25 players and a maximum of 8 overseas players.

Auction

Before the auction, teams are permitted to retain a select number of players for the following season. The rules for retaining players are determined by the league prior to each auction. The salaries of retained players are deducted from the team's salary cap prior to the auction.[81] These players do not participate in the auction and merely continue with their current franchise.

The auction usually takes place in the winter months, in the middle of the IPL's offseason. Players who are not retained, and players who were not attached to a team in the previous tournament, can enter the auction. Each player signs up for the auction, sets their base price and plays for the highest-bidding franchise.[82] Once purchased, the final bid determines the player's salary for that season, and the amount is deducted from the salary cap. Unsold players at the auction can become replacement signings for injured or unavailable players.

The league holds an auction every year, but every 3 years the league will hold a 'mega auction'.[83][84] At this mega auction, teams can only retain a small number of players (6 players at the most recent mega auction)[84] and are required to release a majority of their squad to the auction pool. This system is designed to ensure parity between teams as it forces them to rebuild their squads at regular intervals. Non-mega auctions, where teams can retain a high number of players, are often called 'mini-auctions'.[85]

If a team wants to retain a player who does not want to be retained, the player can request to be traded or released into the auction pool. However, the team has the final say in whether or not to trade or release them. The exception to this is at a mega auction, when the player can demand to be released into the auction pool even if the team intends to retain them.[86]

Trades

Trades require player consent, and any contract differences are covered by the franchise. There are typically three trading windows: two before the auction and one before the tournament. No trading is allowed outside these windows or during the tournament, but replacements can be signed before or during the IPL.

Contracts and salaries

Other notable rules, as of the 2024 season, include:

- The salary cap of the entire squad have been allotted a purse of ₹120 crore each.[87]
- Under-19 players cannot be picked unless they have previously played first-class or List A cricket.[88]

Player contracts run for one year but can be extended by one or two years if the franchises take up the option. Since the 2014 season, player contracts have been denominated in the Indian rupee, before which the contracts were in the US dollar. Overseas players can be remunerated in the currency of the player's choice, at the exchange rate on either the contract due date or the actual payment date.[89] Before the 2014 season, Indian domestic players were not included in the player auction pool. They could be signed up by franchises at a discrete amount while a fixed sum of ₹10 lakh (US$12,000) to ₹30 lakh (US$35,000) would be deducted per signing from the franchise's salary purse. This received significant opposition from franchise owners, who complained richer franchises were "luring players with under-the-table deals." The IPL later decided to include domestic players in the player auction.[90]

The BCCI give 10% of foreign players' salaries to their country's national cricket board.[91]

Based on a 2024 report by *Forbes India*, the average IPL salary among the top 10 highest-paid players is ₹12.37 crore,[92] the second-highest of sports leagues in the world. Because players in the IPL are contracted only for the duration of the tournament – less than two months – the weekly IPL salaries are extrapolated *pro data* to obtain an average annual salary, unlike other sports leagues in which players are contracted by a single team for the entire year.[93]

According to a report by *The Telegraph*, IPL players are paid 18% of the revenue, which is the lowest amount compared to other major sports leagues, in which players receive at least 50% of the revenue. The Federation of International Cricketers' Associations said that IPL players must be paid fairly.[94][95][96]

Here is a table listing the most expensive player acquisitions in each Indian Premier League (IPL) season, along with their respective teams and purchase prices.

List of most expensive player in IPL Auction each year

Year	Auction Location	Player	Nationality	Team	Price INR	Ref.
2008	Mumbai	MS Dhoni	India	Chennai Super Kings	9.5 crore	[97]
2009	Goa	Kevin Pietersen	England	Royal Challengers Bangalore	9.8 crore	[98]
		Andrew Flintoff		Chennai Super Kings		
2010	Bengaluru	Shane Bond	New Zealand	Kolkata Knight Riders	4.8 crore	[99]
		Kieron Pollard	West Indies	Mumbai Indians		
2011		Gautam Gambhir	India	Kolkata Knight Riders	14.9 crore	[100]
2012	Chennai	Ravindra Jadeja		Chennai Super Kings	12.8 crore	[101]
2013		Glenn Maxwell	Australia	Mumbai Indians	6.3 crore	[102]
2014	Dubai	Yuvraj Singh	India	Royal Challengers Bangalore	14 crore	[103]
2015	Bengaluru			Delhi Daredevils	16 crore	[104]
2016		Shane Watson	Australia	Royal Challengers Bangalore	9.5 crore	[105]
2017		Ben Stokes	England	Rising Pune Supergiant	14.5 crore	[106]
2018				Rajasthan Royals	12.5 crore	[107]
2019	Jaipur	Varun Chakravarthy	India	Kings XI Punjab	8.4 crore	[108][109]
2020	Kolkata	Pat Cummins	Australia	Kolkata Knight Riders	15.5 crore	[110]
2021	Chennai	Chris Morris	South Africa	Rajasthan Royals	16.25 crore	
2022	Bengaluru	Ishan Kishan	India	Mumbai Indians	15.25 crore	
2023	Kochi	Sam Curran	England	Punjab Kings	18.5 crore	
2024	Dubai	Mitchell Starc	Australia	Kolkata Knight Riders	24.75 crore	
2025	Jeddah	Rishabh Pant	India	Lucknow Super Giants	27 crore	
2026	Abu Dhabi	Cameron Green	Australia	Kolkata Knight Riders	25.25 crore	

Tournament results

Year	Final			Venue	Player of the Season
	Winner	Result	Runners up		
2008	**Rajasthan Royals** 164/7 (20 overs)	**RR won by 3 wickets** Scorecard (http://www.espncricinfo.com/ipl/engine/match/336040.html)	Chennai Super Kings 163/5 (20 overs)	DY Patil Stadium, Navi Mumbai	Shane Watson (RR)
2009	**Deccan Chargers** 143/6 (20 overs)	**DC won by 6 runs** Scorecard (http://www.espncricinfo.com/ipl2009/engine/match/392239.html)	Royal Challengers Bangalore 137/9 (20 overs)	Wanderers Stadium, Johannesburg	Adam Gilchrist (DC)
2010	**Chennai Super Kings** 168/5 (20 overs)	**CSK won by 22 runs** Scorecard (http://www.espncricinfo.com/ipl2010/engine/match/419165.html)	Mumbai Indians 146/9 (20 overs)	DY Patil Stadium, Navi Mumbai	Sachin Tendulkar (MI)
2011	**Chennai Super Kings** 205/5 (20 overs)	**CSK won by 58 runs** Scorecard (http://www.espncricinfo.com/indian-premier-league-2011/engine/match/501271.html)	Royal Challengers Bangalore 147/8 (20 overs)	M. A. Chidambaram Stadium, Chennai	Chris Gayle (RCB)
2012	**Kolkata Knight Riders** 192/5 (19.4 overs)	**KKR won by 5 wickets** Scorecard (http://www.espncricinfo.com/indian-premier-league-2012/engine/match/548381.html)	Chennai Super Kings 190/3 (20 overs)	M. A. Chidambaram Stadium, Chennai	Sunil Narine (KKR)
2013	**Mumbai Indians** 148/9 (20 overs)	**MI won by 23 runs** Scorecard (http://www.espncricinfo.com/ci/engine/match/598073.html)	Chennai Super Kings 125/9 (20 overs)	Eden Gardens, Kolkata	Shane Watson (RR)
2014	**Kolkata Knight Riders** 200/7 (19.3 overs)	**KKR won by 3 wickets** Scorecard (http://www.espncricinfo.com/indian-premier-league-2014/engine/match/734049.html)	Kings XI Punjab 199/4 (20 overs)	M. Chinnaswamy Stadium, Bengaluru	Glenn Maxwell (KXIP)
2015	**Mumbai Indians** 202/5 (20 overs)	**MI won by 41 runs** Scorecard (http://www.espncricinfo.com/indian-premier-league-2015/engine/match/829823.html)	Chennai Super Kings 161/8 (20 overs)	Eden Gardens, Kolkata	Andre Russell (KKR)
2016	**Sunrisers Hyderabad** 208/7 (20 overs)	**SRH won by 8 runs** Scorecard (http://www.espncricinfo.com/ci/engine/match/981019.html)	Royal Challengers Bangalore 200/7 (20 overs)	M. Chinnaswamy Stadium, Bengaluru	Virat Kohli (RCB)
2017	**Mumbai Indians** 129/8 (20 overs)	**MI won by 1 run** Scorecard (http://www.espncricinfo.com/ci/engine/match/1082650.html)	Rising Pune Supergiant 128/6 (20 overs)	Rajiv Gandhi Stadium, Hyderabad	Ben Stokes (RPS)
2018	**Chennai Super Kings** 181/2 (18.3 overs)	**CSK won by 8 wickets** Scorecard (http://www.espncricinfo.com/series/8048/game/1136620)	Sunrisers Hyderabad 178/6 (20 overs)	Wankhede Stadium, Mumbai	Sunil Narine (KKR)
2019	**Mumbai Indians** 149/8 (20 overs)	**MI won by 1 run** Scorecard (http://www.espncricinfo.com/series/8048/game/1181768)	Chennai Super Kings 148/7 (20 overs)	Rajiv Gandhi Stadium, Hyderabad	Andre Russell (KKR)
2020	**Mumbai Indians** 157/5 (18.4 overs)	**MI won by 5 wickets** Scorecard (https://www.espncricinfo.com/series/8048/game/1237181)	Delhi Capitals 156/7 (20 overs)	Dubai International Stadium, Dubai	Jofra Archer (RR)
2021	**Chennai Super Kings** 192/3 (20 overs)	**CSK won by 27 runs** Scorecard (https://www.iplt20.com/match/2021/60)	Kolkata Knight Riders 165/9 (20 overs)	Dubai International Stadium, Dubai	Harshal Patel (RCB)
2022	**Gujarat Titans** 133/3 (18.1 overs)	**GT won by 7 wickets** Scorecard (https://www.iplt20.com/match/2022/531)	Rajasthan Royals 130/9 (20 overs)	Narendra Modi Stadium, Ahmedabad	Jos Buttler (RR)
2023	**Chennai Super Kings** 171/5 (15 overs)	**CSK won by 5 wickets** (DLS) Scorecard (https://www.espncricinfo.com/ci/engine/match/1370353.html)	Gujarat Titans 214/4 (20 overs)	Narendra Modi Stadium, Ahmedabad	Shubman Gill (GT)
2024	**Kolkata Knight Riders** 114/2 (10.3 overs)	**KKR won by 8 wickets** Scorecard (https://www.espncricinfo.com/series/indian-premier-league-2024-1410320/kolkata-knight-riders-vs-sunrisers-hyderabad-final-1426312/full-scorecard)	Sunrisers Hyderabad 113/10 (18.3 overs)	M. A. Chidambaram Stadium, Chennai	Sunil Narine (KKR)
2025	**Royal Challengers Bengaluru** 190/9 (20 overs)	**RCB won by 6 runs** Scorecard (https://www.espncricinfo.com/series/ipl-2025-1449924/punjab-kings-vs-royal-challengers-bengaluru-final-1473511/full-scorecard)	Punjab Kings 184/7 (20 overs)	Narendra Modi Stadium, Ahmedabad	Suryakumar Yadav (MI)

Performance by teams

Chennai Super Kings and Mumbai Indians have each won five titles, the most in the tournament. Kolkata Knight Riders have won three titles,[111] while Rajasthan Royals, Deccan Chargers, Sunrisers Hyderabad, Gujarat Titans and Royal Challengers Bengaluru have each won a single title.[112][113] The reigning champions are the Royal Challengers Bengaluru, who defeated the Punjab Kings by six runs in the 2025 IPL final to secure their first title.

Team	Won	Runners up	Playoffs Played	Seasons Played
Chennai Super Kings	5 (2010, 2011, 2018, 2021, 2023)	5 (2008, 2012, 2013, 2015, 2019)	12	16
Mumbai Indians	5 (2013, 2015, 2017, 2019, 2020)	1 (2010)	11	18
Kolkata Knight Riders	3 (2012, 2014, 2024)	1 (2021)	8	18
Royal Challengers Bengaluru	1 (2025)	3 (2009, 2011, 2016)	10	18
Sunrisers Hyderabad	1 (2016)	2 (2018, 2024)	7	13
Rajasthan Royals	1 (2008)	1 (2022)	6	16
Gujarat Titans	1 (2022)	1 (2023)	3	4
Deccan Chargers †	1 (2009)		2	5
Punjab Kings		2 (2014, 2025)	3	18
Delhi Capitals		1 (2020)	6	18
Rising Pune Supergiant †		1 (2017)	1	2
Lucknow Super Giants			2	4
Gujarat Lions †			1	2
Pune Warriors India †			–	3
Kochi Tuskers Kerala †			–	1

† Team now defunct

Seasons

Team	2008	2009	2010	2011	2012	2013	2014	2015	2016	2017	2018	2019	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025
Chennai Super Kings	**RU**	SF	**C**	**C**	**RU**	**RU**	3rd	**RU**	*Suspended*		**C**	**RU**	7th	**C**	9th	**C**	5th	10th
Delhi Capitals	SF	SF	5th	10th	3rd	9th	8th	7th	6th	6th	8th	3rd	**RU**	3rd	5th	9th	6th	5th
Gujarat Titans	–														**C**	**RU**	8th	4th
Kolkata Knight Riders	6th	8th	6th	4th	**C**	7th	**C**	5th	4th	3rd	3rd	5th	5th	**RU**	7th	7th	**C**	8th
Lucknow Super Giants	–														4th	4th	7th	7th
Mumbai Indians	5th	7th	**RU**	3rd	4th	**C**	4th	**C**	5th	**C**	5th	**C**	**C**	5th	10th	3rd	10th	3rd
Punjab Kings	SF	5th	8th	5th	6th	6th	**RU**	8th	8th	5th	7th	6th	6th	6th	6th	8th	9th	**RU**
Rajasthan Royals	**C**	6th	7th	6th	7th	3rd	5th	4th	*Suspended*		4th	7th	8th	7th	**RU**	5th	3rd	9th
Royal Challengers Bengaluru	7th	**RU**	3rd	**RU**	5th	5th	7th	3rd	**RU**	8th	6th	8th	4th	4th	3rd	6th	4th	**C**
Sunrisers Hyderabad	–					4th	6th	6th	**C**	4th	**RU**	4th	3rd	8th	8th	10th	**RU**	6th
Defunct Teams																		
Deccan Chargers	8th	**C**	4th	7th	8th	–												
Kochi Tuskers Kerala	–			8th	–													
Pune Warriors India	–			9th	9th	8th	–											
Gujarat Lions	–								3rd	7th	–							
Rising Pune Supergiant	–								7th	**RU**	–							

- Active teams are listed alphabetically. Defunct teams are listed by order of entry to the league, then alphabetically.

Champions
Runners up
Team won the 3rd place playoff; only took place in 2010
Team qualified for the playoffs or semi-final

Positions each season

Year	League Table									
	1st	2nd	3rd	4th	5th	6th	7th	8th	9th	10th
2008	RR	KXIP	CSK	DD	MI	KKR	RCB	DEC		
2009	DD	CSK	RCB	DEC	KXIP	RR	MI	KKR		
2010	MI	DEC	CSK	RCB	DD	KKR	RR	KXIP		
2011	RCB	CSK	MI	KKR	KXIP	RR	DEC	KTK	PWI	DD
2012	DD	KKR	MI	CSK	RCB	KXIP	RR	DEC	PWI	
2013	CSK	MI	RR	SRH	RCB	KXIP	KKR	PWI	DD	
2014	KXIP	KKR	CSK	MI	RR	SRH	RCB	DD		
2015	CSK	MI	RCB	RR	KKR	SRH	DD	KXIP		
2016	GL	RCB	SRH	KKR	MI	DD	RPS	KXIP		
2017	MI	RPS	SRH	KKR	KXIP	DD	GL	RCB		
2018	SRH	CSK	KKR	RR	MI	RCB	KXIP	DD		
2019	MI	CSK	DC	SRH	KKR	KXIP	RR	RCB		
2020	MI	DC	SRH	RCB	KKR	KXIP	CSK	RR		
2021	DC	CSK	RCB	KKR	MI	PBKS	RR	SRH		
2022	GT	RR	LSG	RCB	DC	PBKS	KKR	SRH	CSK	MI
2023	GT	CSK	LSG	MI	RR	RCB	KKR	PBKS	DC	SRH
2024	KKR	SRH	RR	RCB	CSK	DC	LSG	GT	PBKS	MI
2025	PBKS	RCB	GT	MI	DC	SRH	LSG	KKR	RR	CSK

Indicates winner
Indicates runners-up
Indicates qualified for playoffs

All time standings

As of 3 June 2025

Current teams

Team	Appearances			Best result	Statistics						
	Total	First	Latest		Played	Won	Lost	Tied+W	Tied+L	NR	Win%
Chennai Super Kings	16	2008	2025	Champions (2010, 2011, 2018, 2021, 2023)	239	138	98	0	1	2	57.74
Mumbai Indians	18	2008	2025	Champions (2013, 2015, 2017, 2019, 2020)	261	142	115	2	2	0	54.40
Kolkata Knight Riders	18	2008	2025	Champions (2012, 2014, 2024)	252	130	117	1	3	0	52.40
Rajasthan Royals	16	2008	2025	Champions (2008)	222	110	106	2	1	2	50.91
Sunrisers Hyderabad	13	2013	2025	Champions (2016)	182	87	91	1	3	0	49.17
Gujarat Titans	4	2022	2025	Champions (2022)	45	28	17	0	0	0	62.22
Royal Challengers Bengaluru	18	2008	2025	Champions (2025)	256	121	128	2	1	4	48.61
Deccan Chargers	5	2008	2012	Champions (2009)	75	29	46	0	0	0	38.66
Punjab Kings	18	2008	2025	Runners-up (2014, 2025)	246	109	133	3	1	0	45.12
Delhi Capitals	18	2008	2025	Runners-up (2020)	252	112	134	3	1	2	44.44
Rising Pune Supergiant	2	2016	2017	Runners-up (2017)	30	15	15	0	0	0	50.00
Lucknow Super Giants	4	2022	2025	Eliminator (2022, 2023)	44	24	19	0	0	1	54.54
Gujarat Lions	2	2016	2017	Qualifier 2 (2016)	30	13	16	0	1	0	45.00
Pune Warriors India	3	2011	2013	Group stage (2011, 2012, 2013)	46	12	33	0	0	1	26.67
Kochi Tuskers Kerala	1	2011	2011	Group stage (2011)	14	6	8	0	0	0	42.85

Source (https://www.espncricinfo.com/records/trophy/team-results-summary/indian-premier-league-117)

Defunct team

Records and statistics

As of 3 June 2025

Batting records		
Most runs	Virat Kohli (RCB)	8,661
Most fours		771
Most sixes	Chris Gayle (KKR/PBKS/RCB)	357
Most centuries	Virat Kohli (RCB)	8
Most half-centuries		63
Most runs in a season		973 (2016)
Best strike rate	Phil Salt (DC/KKR/RCB)	175.71
Highest score	Chris Gayle (RCB)	175* vs Pune Warriors India (23 April 2013)
Highest partnership	Virat Kohli and AB de Villiers (RCB)	229 vs Gujarat Lions (14 May 2016)
Bowling records		
Most wickets	Yuzvendra Chahal (PBKS/MI/RCB/RR)	221
Best bowling figures	Alzarri Joseph (MI)	6/12 vs Sunrisers Hyderabad (6 April 2019)
Most wickets in a season	Harshal Patel (RCB)	32 (2021)
	Dwayne Bravo (CSK)	32 (2013)
Fielding records		
Most dismissals as a wicket-keeper	MS Dhoni (CSK/RPS)	201
Most catches as a fielder	Virat Kohli (RCB)[114]	117
Team records		
Highest total	Sunrisers Hyderabad	287/3 (20) vs Royal Challengers Bengaluru (15 April 2024)
Lowest total	Royal Challengers Bangalore	49 (9.4) vs Kolkata Knight Riders (23 April 2017)

Source (https://www.iplt20.com/stats/)

Virat Kohli is the highest run-scorer in IPL.

Yuzvendra Chahal is the highest wicket-taker in IPL.

Most appearances

As of 3 June 2025

Rank	Player	Team	Years active	Apps	Runs	Wkts
1	**MS Dhoni**	CSK, RPS	2008–present	**278**	5,439	–
2	**Rohit Sharma**	DCH, MI		**272**	7,046	15
3	**Virat Kohli**	RCB		**267**	8,661	4
4	Dinesh Karthik	DD, GL, KKR, KXIP, MI, RCB	2008–2024	**257**	4,842	–
5	**Ravindra Jadeja**	CSK, GL, KTK, RR	2008–present	**254**	3,260	170
6	Shikhar Dhawan	DD, DCH, MI, PBKS, SRH	2008–2024	**222**	6,769	4
7	Ravichandran Ashwin	CSK, DC, KXIP, RR, RPS	2009–2025	**221**	833	187
8	Suresh Raina	CSK, GL	2008–2021	**205**	5,528	25
9	Robin Uthappa	CSK, KKR, PWI, RR, RCB	2008–2022	**205**	4,952	–
10	Ambati Rayudu	CSK, MI	2010–2023	**204**	4,348	–

- Source: ESPNcricinfo[115]
- Currently active IPL players appear in **boldface**.

End-of-season awards

Prize money

Starting with the 2025 season, the distribution of the prize money is as follows.

- Winning team: ₹20 crore (US$2.4 million)
- Runner-up team: ₹12 crore (US$1.4 million)
- Third-place team: ₹7 crore (US$830,000)

- Fourth-place team: ₹6.5 crore (US$770,000)

Fair Play Award

The Fair Play Award is given to the team considered to have the best fair play record in the season. After each match, the two on-field umpires and the third umpire score the performance of both teams, with the highest-scoring team at the end of the season receiving the award.[116] The 2025 winners were Chennai Super Kings, who won it for the seventh time.

Orange Cap

The Orange Cap is awarded to the highest run-scorer at the end of each season. It is an ongoing competition with the current highest run-scorer wearing the cap whilst fielding. The eventual winner keeps the cap for the season. Brendon McCullum was the first player to wear the Orange Cap and Shaun Marsh the inaugural winner of the award. Australian batsman David Warner has won the award three times, while Chris Gayle and Virat Kohli have each won it twice.[117] Sai Sudharsan of Gujarat Titans, who scored 759 runs during the 2025 season, is the most recent winner of the award.[118][119]

Purple Cap

The Purple Cap is awarded to the highest wicket-taker at the end of each season. It is an ongoing competition and the bowler who is the leading wicket-taker wears a purple cap whilst fielding. The eventual winner keeps the cap for the season. Bhuvneshwar Kumar and Dwayne Bravo are the only players to have won the award twice.[120][121] Prasidh Krishna of Gujarat Titans, who took 25 wickets during the 2025 season, is the most recent winner of the award.

Most Valuable Player

The Most Valuable Player award, formerly called the "Man of the Tournament" until the 2012 season, is awarded using a ratings system introduced in 2013. Suryakumar Yadav won the award in 2025.

Emerging Player Award

The Emerging Player Award was presented to the best under-19 player in 2008 and the best under-23 player in 2009 and 2010. In 2011 and 2012, the award was known as "Rising Star of the Year," and in 2013 the "Best Young Player of the Season." Since 2014, the award has been called the Emerging Player of the Year. Mustafizur Rahman is the only foreign player to win this award.[122] The 2025 winner was Sai Sudharsan.

Finances

Title sponsorship

From 2008 to 2012, the IPL title sponsor was DLF, a real estate developer, which bid ₹200 crore (US$24 million).[125] After 2012, PepsiCo bought the rights for ₹397 crore (US$47 million) for five seasons,[126] but terminated the deal in 2015, two years before expiry, due to the two-season suspension of the Chennai and Rajasthan franchises.[127] The BCCI transferred the rights for those two seasons to Chinese smartphone manufacturer Vivo for ₹200 crore (US$24 million).[128]

Title sponsorship fees[123]

Sponsor	Period	Estimated annual sponsorship fee
DLF	2008–2012	₹40 crore (US$9 million)
Pepsi	2013–2015	₹79 crore (US$13 million)
Vivo	2016–2017	₹100 crore (US$15 million)
	2018–2019, 2021	₹440 crore (US$64 million)
Dream11	2020	₹222 crore (US$30 million)
Tata	2022–2023	₹335 crore (US$43 million)
	2024–2028	₹500 crore (US$59 million)[124]

In 2017, Vivo retained the rights for 2018–22 with a winning bid of ₹2,199 crore (US$260 million).[129][130] In August 2020, Vivo canceled the rights due to a military stand-off between India and China.[131] The withdrawal was also a result of Vivo's market losses due to the COVID pandemic; Vivo intended to return as sponsor for the following three years.[132] Dream11 became sponsors for 2020 for ₹222 crore (equivalent to ₹261 crore or US$31 million in 2023).[133] Vivo returned for 2021[134] but withdrew again, and was replaced by the Tata Group for the next two seasons.[135] *InsideSport* reported the BCCI would receive ₹498 crore (US$59 million) for the 2022–23 seasons from title sponsors. Vivo had agreed to pay a higher amount for the last two seasons of its contract due to the league's expansion from 2022. Due to the new deal's structure, Tata would pay ₹335 crore (US$40 million) per year while Vivo would pay the deficit of ₹163 crore (US$19 million).[136][137] Aramco bought the sponsorship rights for the Orange and Purple Caps in 2022.[138]

Crowd during a match of the 2023 IPL season in Kolkata

Payments to foreign national boards

The BCCI pays 10% of the auctioned value of players to their national cricket boards. In 2018, IPL chairman Rajiv Shukla said the IPL would double the amount paid to cricket boards that made their players available for an entire season.[139] In 2022, the Australian Cricketers' Association expressed its unhappiness about this.[91]

Brand value

The IPL tournament rapidly grew in value between 2016 and 2018. Experts valued it at US$4.2 billion in 2016, $5.3 billion in 2017 and $6.1 billion in 2018. A report from Duff & Phelps said a contributing factor was a television deal with Star India Private Limited, which engaged more viewers because the IPL was transmitted to regional channels in eight languages; under the previous deal, transmissions were limited to sports networks with English-language commentary.[140][141]

In 2022, the IPL became a decacorn valued at US$11 billion, registering a 75% growth since 2020 when it was valued at $6.2 billion.[142]

Brand value

Team	Year				
	2025	2024[143]	2023[144]	2022[145][146][147]	2021[145]
	Brand value	Brand value	Brand value	Brand value	Brand value
Royal Challengers Bengaluru	$269M	$117M	$70M	$68M	$50M
Mumbai Indians	$242M	$119M	$87M	$83M	$80M
Chennai Super Kings	$235M	$122M	$81M	$74M	$76M
Kolkata Knight Riders	$227M	$109M	$79M	$77M	$66M
Sunrisers Hyderabad	$154M	$85M	$48M	$49M	$52M
Delhi Capitals	$152M	$80M	$64M	$62M	$56M
Rajasthan Royals	$146M	$81M	$62M	$61M	$34M
Gujarat Titans	$142M	$69M	$65M	$47M	N/A
Punjab Kings	$141M	$68M	$45M	$45M	$36M
Lucknow Super Giants	$122M	$60M	$47M	$32M	N/A

In 2022, the BCCI took insurance of ₹5,000 crore (US$590 million) for the IPL. This policy involves all stakeholders, including broadcasters, ancillary services providers, and sponsors. The BCCI is covered in case of revenue losses due to weather, riots, and unforeseen events.[148]

Broadcasting

The IPL has been India's most-watched sports property; JioCinema estimated that an average of 620 million viewers watched part of the 2024 Indian Premier League overall, with at least 350 billion minutes streamed across the tournament.[149] The 2025 final was seen on Star Sports by 169 million viewers, making it the most-watched cricket broadcast to-date on linear television.[150]

Currently, domestic media rights are held by JioStar, under contracts originally awarded in 2022 to its corporate predecessors Disney Star and Viacom18; coverage is carried via its streaming service JioHotstar, and the Star Sports pay television networks.[151][152] The main packages for domestic television and digital rights were collectively valued at around US$6.2 billion (more than double the value of the previous contract), causing the IPL to overtake the Premier League in English football as the second highest-valued sports media property worldwide, behind only the National Football League (US$111 billion).[153][154][155][156]

The IPL's media rights were originally held from 2008 to 2017 by Sony Pictures Networks (domestic) and World Sport Group (international) under a ten-year contract valued at US$1.03 billion.[157][158] Coverage was split between SPN channels such as Sony Max (which primarily carried coverage in the Hindi language), Sony Six (Hindi, Bengali, Tamil, Kannada and Telugu), and Sony ESPN (English).[159] SPN also produced *Extraaa Innings T20*, an aftershow that combined post-match analysis with entertainment features such as celebrity guests and interviews.[160][161]

The media rights were then held by Star India from 2018 to 2022, under a contract valued at US$2.55 billion—which, at the time, was the highest-valued broadcast rights contract in the history of cricket. Star Sports would hold the pay television rights, while Disney+ Hotstar held the digital rights.[162][163][164][165] In 2022, Disney Star lost the digital rights to a consortium of Reliance Industries and Viacom18 (which would stream the IPL for free via their streaming service JioCinema),[166] while maintaining the pay television rights for Star Sports. The loss of IPL rights notably contributed to Disney losing 2.4 million Disney+ subscribers worldwide in fiscal Q4 2022.[167][168]

List of broadcasters

Territory	Channels	Years
India	Star Sports 1 Star Sports 1 Hindi Star Sports 1 Kannada Star Sports 1 Tamil Star Sports 1 Telugu HD Star Gold Star Bharat Star Utsav Movies Star Jalsa Movies Star Maa Movies Star Suvarna Plus Star Vijay Super Colors Tamil Asianet Movies	2024–2027
	JioHotstar (Digital)	2024–2027
Afghanistan	ATN HD ATN News HD	2024
	Ariana Television (Digital)	2024
Australia	Foxtel Fox Cricket Kayo Sports	2023–present[169]
	Kayo Freebies (Digital)	2023–present[169]
Bangladesh	T Sports HD	2024
	T Sports APP	2024
Indonesia	Vidio (Digital)	2023[170]
New Zealand	Colors TV	2024–present
Nepal	Kantipur Max	2025
Pakistan	Tapmad APP	2024
Ireland	Sky Sports DAZN	2023–present
United Kingdom		
South Africa	SuperSport	2023[169]
Sri Lanka	Star Sports 1 Star Sports 1 HD Star Sports 2 Star Sports Select HD 1 Star Sports Select HD 2	
	Supreme TV	2023–present
	SandBrix (Digital)	2025
United States	Willow TV	2023[169]
Middle East and North Africa	Times Internet	2023[169]
Sub-Saharan Africa	SuperSport	2021–present

Controversies

Spot-fixing and betting cases

In the 2012 IPL spot-fixing case, the BCCI imposed a lifetime ban on Deccan Chargers player TP Sudhindra and suspended four other players.[171] In a sting operation, Pune Warriors India player Mohnish Mishra was recorded alleging that IPL franchise owners paid players black money, over and above their salaries. Mishra later apologized for his "frivolous and incorrect statements".[172][173]

In the 2013 IPL spot-fixing and betting case, Delhi police arrested Rajasthan Royals players Ajit Chandila, Ankeet Chavan and S. Sreesanth on charges of spot-fixing; they received lifetime bans from the BCCI. The police also arrested Gurunath Meiyappan, the team principal of Chennai Super Kings and son-in-law of then BCCI president N. Srinivasan, for illegally betting on IPL matches and passing team information to bookmakers.[174][175] In 2015, the Lodha Committee, appointed by the Supreme Court of India, banned Rajasthan Royals and Chennai Super Kings for two years. Meiyappan and Rajasthan Royals co-owner Raj Kundra were found guilty of betting and banned from any involvement with the game. Justice RM Lodha said, "Disrepute has been brought to cricket, the BCCI and the IPL to such an extent that there are doubts abound in the public whether the game is clean or not."[176]

Strategic timeouts

In the 2009 season, the IPL introduced the "strategic timeout", a seven-and-a-half minute break at the end of the tenth over in each innings.[177] Teams and players, including Sachin Tendulkar, disapproved of it for interrupting the flow of play,[178] while critics labelled it a "commercial use of an extended drinks break" as every 10-second advertisement slot was sold for over ₹5 lakh.[179][180] The then-president of the IPL insisted that the break was intended to allow teams to strategise during the game. Following widespread criticism, in the 2010 season, the duration of the timeout was reduced to five minutes, split in two halves during each innings.[180][181]

IPL stakeholders have described strategic timeouts as unavoidable, as they provide the BCCI with sponsorship revenue and allow broadcasters additional time for advertisements.[179] In 2022, commentator Sunil Gavaskar said that strategic timeouts, among other factors, caused IPL matches to stretch to nearly 4 hours, instead of the stipulated time of 3 hours and 10 minutes.[182]

Incidents with players

During the 2008 season, Mumbai Indians player Harbhajan Singh slapped S. Sreesanth at the end of a match, resulting in Harbhajan being fined and banned from the remaining games of the season.[183] Years later, Harbhajan apologized to Sreesanth on television.[184][185]

In 2010, the BCCI banned Ravindra Jadeja from the IPL for one year after he violated league guidelines by negotiating a more lucrative contract with other teams instead of renewing his contract with the Rajasthan Royals.[186]

Team ownership controversies

In April 2010, IPL commissioner Lalit Modi revealed that Sunanda Pushkar, who was described at the time as a "close friend" of the Minister of State for External Affairs Shashi Tharoor, held sweat equity shares in Rendezvous Sports World (RSW), the proprietor of the newly auctioned franchise Kochi Tuskers Kerala. Since Tharoor had mentored RSW's successful bid for the Kochi franchise, members of his Indian National Congress party demanded his resignation. Pushkar gave up her 4.7% sweat equity estimated to be worth ₹70 crore, while Tharoor resigned over charges of conflict of interest and allegations that Pushkar was acting as a proxy for him.[187][188] Tharoor married Pushkar in August later that year.[189]

In April 2010, the BCCI president Shashank Manohar claimed in a press conference that the IPL Governing Council did not know the true owners of the Rajasthan Royals (RR) and Kings XI Punjab (KXIP). He stated that during the franchise bidding process, only Preity Zinta had initially come forward to bid for KXIP, but the franchise agreement was later signed by a different company in which she held no ownership stake. He cited similar irregularities in the bidding process for RR, adding that the BCCI's permission had not been sought before the owners of RR sold a part stake to Shilpa Shetty and Raj Kundra, and that the mandatory 5% share transfer fee had not been paid.[190][191] Both franchises were briefly terminated in October 2010 over alleged violations of the franchise agreement,[192][193][194] before the terminations were overturned by the Bombay High Court in December 2010.[195][196]

In April 2010, former BCCI president A. C. Muthiah filed a Supreme Court petition against Chennai Super Kings (CSK) owner N. Srinivasan, claiming that the then-BCCI president Srinivasan altered BCCI's rules to allow himself to purchase an IPL team and that owning an IPL team was a case of conflict of interest.[197] A few months later, Indian media, citing an alleged leaked e-mail, accused former IPL commissioner Lalit Modi of helping Srinivasan's team buy Andrew Flintoff in the 2009 player auction.[198] During a hearing of the 2013 betting case in which Srinivasan's son-in-law and CSK's team principal Gurunath Meiyappan was suspended by the Lodha Committee,[199] the Supreme Court criticized Srinivasan for owning an IPL team while serving as the BCCI president.[200] As of 2024, Srinivasan's family was reported to exercise control over Chennai Super Kings Cricket through a significant ownership stake;[201] his daughter Rupa Gurunath often appears in stadiums during CSK's games.

Slow over rates

Field umpires sometimes penalize teams by restricting them to having only four fielders outside the 30-yard area, or match referees penalize captains and team members by reducing their match fees, but these measures have not solved the problem. Games often run at a slow speed and finish late. During the 2024 season, Rishabh Pant, captain of Delhi Capitals, and Shubman Gill of Gujarat Titans were fined ₹12 lakhs each for their teams' slow over rates during matches against Chennai Super Kings.[202] Millions of viewers feel that IPL matches should be fast-paced.[203]

Security issues

Ahead of the 2009 season, the Indian government declined to provide security for the IPL, citing that central security forces would be engaged in the general elections.[204] As a result, the BCCI shifted the season to South Africa.[205] A similar decision by the Indian government in 2014, when the IPL again coincided with the general elections,[206] led to the opening 20 matches being held in the United Arab Emirates, with the tournament returning to India on 2 May 2014.[207]

On 9 May 2025, the 2025 season was suspended for one week during the India-Pakistan conflict.[208][209] As several airports in North India were closed, the Indian Railways organized special Vande Bharat Express trains for players, support staff, commentators, production crew members, and operations staff on the request of the BCCI.[210]

Exclusion of Pakistani and Bangladeshi players

Following the November 2008 terrorist attacks in Mumbai by Pakistan-based terrorist group Lashkar-e-Taiba, geopolitical tensions surged between India and Pakistan. The aftermath of the attack led to the exclusion of Pakistani players from playing in the IPL, as none of them were picked by any team during the 2009 IPL auction.[211] While they had been selected by several teams for the inaugural IPL season (2008), their contracts were terminated before the 2009 edition, and have been excluded for subsequent editions.[212] Among the critics of the BCCI and IPL owners has been retired cricketer and former Pakistan prime minister Imran Khan, who stated that they "take it out on Pakistan players". He accused the BCCI of "arrogance" but also stated that "Pakistan should not worry about it".[213] Certain Pakistani players, including Hasan Ali and Sohail Tanvir expressed disappointment about not getting an opportunity to be a part of the IPL.[214][215] In addition to the exclusion of Pakistani players from the IPL, India refused to play with Pakistan in any bilateral series and pulled out from the 2009 series.[216]

For the 2010 IPL season auction, as no franchise bid for any Pakistani player, it led to major protests in Pakistan.[217] As a result of not being selected, several players such as Shahid Afridi and Abdul Razzaq expressed disappointment, while former leg spinner Abdul Qadir stated that Pakistan should form its own league.[218] Subsequently, it led to the formation of Pakistan Super League, which had its first season in 2016.[219]

During the 2025 IPL auction on 24 and 25 November 2024 at Jeddah, Saudi Arabia, 13 Bangladeshi players were registered, out of which 12 were auctioned.[220] However, none of the players were sold, prompting a backlash from Bangladeshi fans and cricketers.[221] After the auction concluded, the exclusion of Bangladeshi players was largely supported by Indians following the violence against Hindus in Bangladesh in the

aftermath of resignation of Sheikh Hasina on 5 August 2024.[222]

Following the 2026 IPL auction in December 2025 at Abu Dhabi, controversy arose after Kolkata Knight Riders bought Bangladeshi cricketer Mustafizur Rahman, due to the geopolitical tensions caused by the violence against Hindus and lynching of Dipu Chandra Das in December 2025.[223] Following an outcry and widespread condemnation across India, the BCCI on 3 January 2026 requested the team to release Rahman.[224] The incident led to the Bangladesh Cricket Board request the International Cricket Council to shift their matches against India in the 2026 Men's T20 World Cup, co-hosted by India and Sri Lanka, to be solely held in Sri Lanka, similar to that of Pakistan's.[225][226] Due to unresolved disagreements between the ICC and BCB, the Bangladesh team was later officially replaced by the Scotland team.[227]

Clash with PSL and KPL

The IPL has occasionally clashed with the Pakistan Super League (PSL) and the Kashmir Premier League, due to scheduling overlaps and geopolitical sensitivities. Several players have reportedly been warned by the BCCI against participating in the KPL, given the political sensitivity surrounding the Kashmir region.[228] Former South African player Herschelle Gibbs publicly accused the Board of Control for Cricket in India of pressuring him not to play in the inaugural KPL and threatening to deny him entry into India for any cricket-related work if he participated.[229]

Additionally, some players eligible for the PSL have reportedly chosen to play in the IPL instead, citing higher financial incentives and greater international exposure.[230] This trend has limited the PSL's ability to attract and retain top foreign talent.[231]

See also

Cricket portal

- Cricket in India
- Sport in India – overview of Indian sports culture
- List of cricket leagues in India
- List of professional sports leagues in India

Notes

a. Indian cricket leagues established using similar formats to the IPL include the Women's Premier League and various domestic state-level leagues. Leagues established in other sports include the association football Indian Super League,[9] the Pro Kabaddi League and Pro Volleyball League[10] Other international leagues have also adopted elements of the IPL and been influenced by the business model used.
b. Denotes minority stakes

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External links

- Official website (https://www.iplt20.com/)
- Tournament home (https://stats.espncricinfo.com/ci/engine/records/index.html?id=117;type=trophy) on ESPNcricinfo

Retrieved from "https://en.wikipedia.org/w/index.php?title=Indian_Premier_League&oldid=1339417289"